



Smart Siri

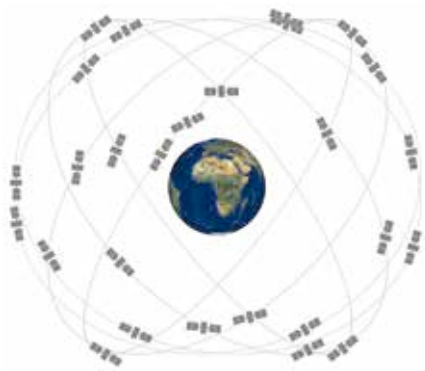
Siri in iOS 7 will ask users to teach her to pronounce a difficult name



Ubuntu Edge smartphone

Dual-booting Android & Ubuntu, it sports a 4.5-inch display, multi-core CPU, 4GB of RAM, and 128GB of built-in storage. <http://dgit.in/13WkBn9>

Feature



Global Positioning System(GPS)

less challenging, and thus less fun. To hide your own geocache, ensure that you register it online after reading all the rules about how to make it interesting and what counts as a legitimate cache. Don't play pranks. Read Geocaching 101 on www.geocaching.com/guide/ before setting off on your first adventure.

Amping up the Fun

As much fun as it is for most geocachers, some of them are really passionate about this activity. They plan treasure hunts across the world, where a clue in one cache leads to another. Some enthusiasts want their trinkets to travel the world. These items are called 'hitchhikers'. So when someone finds a cache with a hitchhiker, he reads up about where it wants to go, takes the hitchhiker with him and hides it in a cache closer to its destination for someone else to find. They might have logbooks attached to log their travel. The geocachers also log their activity online to share it with the geocaching community. The Groundspeak forum on Geocaching (<http://dgit.in/134icHK>) is very useful since fellow geocachers are more than happy to help.

There are different kinds of interesting geocaches. In 2001, with the release of the movie Planet of the Apes, Fox Studios worked in conjunction with Geocaching.com and placed original artifacts from the movie in 14 geocaches. These were called the Project A.P.E cache, and only one of them still exists today. Another type of cache is a Webcam cache. With the cache co-ordinates, you have to find a camera installed by an individual or agency to monitor public places, get in

front of it and ask your friend to log on to the website and save the picture to log the cache. The webcam cache is not really accepted today but those that did exist beforehand are allowed by Geocaching.com, and managed by Waymarking.com, another website managed by Groundspeak. For a complete list of the different types of caches, visit <http://dgit.in/17uXhBc>

You can plan your own geocaching adventure or participate in one organized by your locality. Geocaching has become so popular that school teachers are taking students on educational geocaching field trips. The students learn about latitude, longitude and the basics of GPS. By careful selection of the cache, they learn about the history of specific places. Now who said learning isn't fun!

The Origin of Geocaching

'Letterboxing' was a precursor to geocaching. It's exactly like geocaching, except that there wasn't any GPS back when it was popular. People used to hide



The very first geocache

containers at public places and distribute clues and hints in printed catalogs or by word of mouth. The containers were called 'letterboxes' and usually contained a logbook for the visitors, as a proof of having found the letterbox. Another similar method of hiding objects for others to find is called 'dead drop' or 'dead letter box'. It's a method of 'espionage tradecraft'. One individual hides some piece of information, and gives the clue to another to find it.

The first geocache was placed on May 3, 2000, by Dave Ulmer. Geocaching was originally referred to as 'stash-hunt'. Nowadays, there's another outdoor game that's similar to geocaching called



This is how a GeoCheckpoint looks like

'GeoCheckpointing' that calls for the use of GPS to find control points called 'GeoCheckpoints'. Each of these points will take you to an interesting place around the world, be it a monument, landmark or some charming place in the hard-to-reach corners of the city. It's similar to 'waymarking' which is a way to share the co-ordinates and details of cool locations with the world. You can plan your own adventurous treasure hunts using pictures and GPS co-ordinates at Locomatrix.com. Tourality is another location-based multi-player game available in major app stores such as Android Market, Ovi Store, BlackBerry App World and Apple App Store. Unlike geocaching, in Tourality time matters. Your real environment serves as a virtual playground, and your target is to reach predefined spots with the help of your GPS device, and reach there fast. The game is made more interesting by virtual gold, trophies, gadgets and more.

Geocaching in India

Unfortunately, India is not so active on the geocaching front. Only about 1.5% of the geocachers hail from India. Mostly because not many people know about this sport. The few geocachers that are there are disappointed with the modest number of caches in our country. One huge concern of theirs is the recurring construction work that happens in the cities, because of which the caches often go missing. It's said that caches in India get mugged often.

Don't let that discourage you. The list of all the active geocaches hidden in India can be found here <http://dgit.in/15yEDXJ>. You can meet other geocachers from India and rest of Asia over at this forum <http://dgit.in/13uDGkt>